

Space asks for controlled expansion

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

More space can improve mobility and restrict enemy pieces, but advanced pawns need defense. Keep enough tension to stop the opponent from exchanging cramped pieces freely, while remaining alert to freeing breaks.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If you hold a broad center, exchanging all central pawns may release the opponent's bishops and rooks. On the other hand, refusing an exchange that loses a pawn is not a sensible way to preserve space.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should a cramped side often seek?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Useful exchanges and freeing pawn breaks. The side with more space should recognize those plans and decide which can be prevented without overextending.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Use space to improve coordination while watching the opponent's release valves.